

Gene Mauch Platoons To Study His Players

BY JERRY HOWE
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PHILADELPHIA, April 22 — Gene Mauch, new Philadelphia manager who took over for Eddie Sawyer after the second game of the season, is using the shakewell system to become acquainted with the Phillies.

Mauch is alternating his personnel in at least half the positions according to whether the opposition's pitcher is a right-hander or lefthander.

"I know some of these guys pretty well now, but others I don't know too much about," Mauch explained. "I've got to find out what they can do."

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Jay Hook, tonight's starting pitcher for the Reds, says a better change-up has been the biggest improvement in his pitching this year.

"I've worked on it a lot this spring," Hook said. "I guess that is about the only change I've made. My control was good the last time out, didn't walk a batter but I'm not making any predictions on how it will be to-

night," Hook said in the locker room before the game. He must have had a premonition of what was to come.

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Vada Pinson and Frank Robinson, both struggling to snap out of their early batting slump, got in some extra hitting practice this afternoon.

Each took a 20-minute session. Both are getting considerable attention from coach Wally Moses. Pinson was batting a feeble .148 and Robinson .214 going into tonight's game.

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Manager Fred Hutchinson put Redleg rookie Tony Gonzalez back in rightfield tonight in place of Lee Walls. Pancho Herrera of the Phillies must be one of the biggest ever to play second base. He's 6-4 and weighs about 215.

There's talk here that Cincinnati catcher Frank House may be involved in a trade to the Phillies soon.

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Hutchinson warded off a hot smash with his bare hands while

standing in the infield during batting practice tonight.

One of the Redleg players quipped: "You'll wait all night if you expect to see him rub his hands. You couldn't hurt him with a baseball bat.

"I've seen him hit concrete walls in dugouts and clubhouses with his bare hands until the blood flowed from his knuckles. I think he's indestructible."

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Andy Cohen, Phillie coach, was speaking about Robin Roberts, tonight's starter. "In Spring training he was throwing hard, but since we got back all he's been throwing is junk."

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Cal McLish, belted out in his first start for the Reds, is to make a second try tomorrow in the second of this four-game series. He'll be opposed by John Buzhardt.

Probables for Sunday's double-header are Don Newcombe and Bob Purkey for the Reds and Jim Owens and Don Cardwell for the Phils.